DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 3

Bookkeeper (including QuickBooks consultant)

Profession 3 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A bookkeeper records a business's financial transactions accurately. A QuickBooks consultant sets up and maintains the QuickBooks accounting software for clients. This is record-keeping, not regulated accounting or tax advice.

What professionals do every day

Records invoices and expenses, reconciles bank accounts, categorises transactions, prepares reports for the accountant, and sets up QuickBooks for clients.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Accurate records make tax filing and financial decisions possible. Bookkeepers keep them clean and on time.

- Transactions recorded in the wrong category.
- Bank accounts that do not reconcile.
- Late invoices and missed payments.

Skills you need

- Accounting basics.
- Bank reconciliation.
- QuickBooks Online setup.
- Records and confidentiality.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
QuickBooks Online	Accounting software	Trial (check current offer)	Subscription	quickbooks.intuit.com
Zoho Books	Accounting software for small firms	Free plan (check current)	Paid plans	www.zoho.com/books/
Google Workspace	Mail, calendar, documents	Free personal account	Paid business plans	workspace.google.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Reconcile one month of bank lines.
Intermediate	Categorise 30 transactions with a rule list.

Advanced	Create one invoice template with a numbering rule.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Monthly reconciliation for a shop.
- **Intermediate:** Invoice set-up for a consultant.
- **Advanced:** Expense categorisation for a start-up.

Client-ready portfolio project

A monthly bookkeeping pack for a fictional shop: reconciled bank lines, categorised transactions, unmatched items list and a note for the accountant.

Worked example

Worked example. A bank line of 1,200 on 1 March matches the invoice of 1,200 on the same date; a line of 800 with no invoice is listed as unmatched for the owner to explain.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Reconcile a month

Business problem: A shop's bank statement must be matched to its ledger before the accountant's review.

Steps

1. Export the bank lines and the ledger entries.
2. Match by date and amount (use the tested matcher in Module C).
3. List every unmatched item on both sides.
4. Write a note for the accountant.

Expected output: The matches, the unmatched list and the note.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

PYTHON

```
import re

def clean_phone(raw):
    digits = re.sub(r"\D", "", raw)
    if digits.startswith("91") and len(digits) == 12:
        digits = digits[2:]
    return digits if len(digits) == 10 else None

def valid_email(raw):
    return bool(re.fullmatch(r"[^@\s]+@[^@\s]+\.[^@\s]+", raw.strip()))

def validate_record(rec):
    errors = []
    if not rec.get("name", "").strip():
        errors.append("name missing")
```

```
    if not valid_email(rec.get("email", "")):
        errors.append("email invalid")
    if clean_phone(rec.get("phone", "")) is None:
        errors.append("phone must be 10 digits (after removing +91)")
    return errors

def reconcile(bank, ledger):
    """Match bank lines to ledger entries by amount and date. Returns matched, unmatched_bank,
unmatched_ledger."""
    remaining = list(ledger)
    matched, unmatched_bank = [], []
    for b in bank:
        hit = next((l for l in remaining if l["amount"] == b["amount"] and l["date"] ==
b["date"]), None)
        if hit:
            matched.append((b["id"], hit["id"])); remaining.remove(hit)
        else:
            unmatched_bank.append(b["id"])
    return matched, unmatched_bank, [l["id"] for l in remaining]

bank=[{'id':'B1','date':'2026-03-01','amount':1200},{'id':'B2','date':'2026-03-
02','amount':800},{'id':'B3','date':'2026-03-03','amount':500}]
ledger=[{'id':'L1','date':'2026-03-01','amount':1200},{'id':'L2','date':'2026-03-
02','amount':900}]
matched, unmatched_bank, unmatched_ledger = reconcile(bank, ledger)
print(matched, unmatched_bank, unmatched_ledger)
assert matched == [('B1','L1')]
assert unmatched_bank == ['B2','B3'] and unmatched_ledger == ['L2']
print('reconciliation test passed')
```

Common mistakes

- Recording transactions without receipts.
- Mixing personal and business money.
- Giving tax advice.
- Not backing up the books.

Freelancing opportunities

- Monthly bookkeeping for small firms and freelancers.
- QuickBooks set-up and clean-ups.
- Briefs for 'bookkeeping', 'QuickBooks', 'bank reconciliation'. Tax filing belongs to a qualified professional.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- QuickBooks Learn and Support (verify)

Part of **Master Freelancing: Admin and Business Support**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.